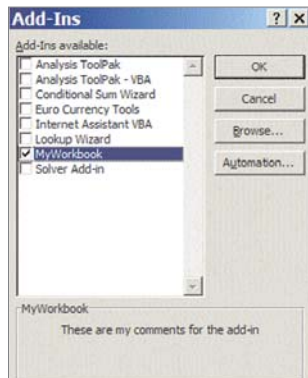


Save a Workbook as an add-in by selecting "Add-Ins" under Save As



After you've saved your add-in, it will show up under "Add-Ins"

the 'Tools' menu. This displays the 'Add-Ins' dialog box. If your custom add-in is visible in the dialog box, click the checkbox beside it and click 'OK'—you're done. Otherwise, click 'Browse', and use the controls in the dialog box to locate and select your custom add-in.

Automatically Loading Add-ins

First load the worksheet for which you want a specific add-in loaded. Then press [Alt] + [F11] to display the VBA Editor. Double-click on the 'This Workbook' object in the Project Explorer. Excel opens a code window for This Workbook. Place the following macros in the code window:

```
Private Sub
Workbook_BeforeClose(Cancel As Boolean)
AddIns("Add-In
Name").Installed = False
End Sub
Private Sub
Workbook_Open()
AddIns("Add-In
Name").Installed = True
End Sub
(In the code, change "Add-In
Name" to the name of the
add-in.)
```

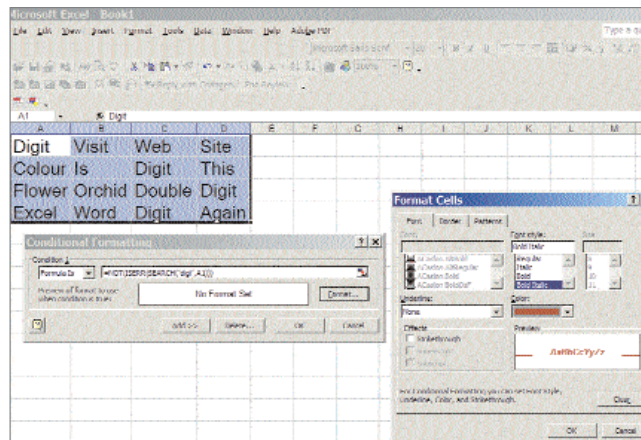
Close the VBA Editor and

save your worksheet. If you're not sure of the correct name for a particular add-in, you can use the macro recorder to record the process of activating an add-in. That will show you the exact name you should use in the above macros.

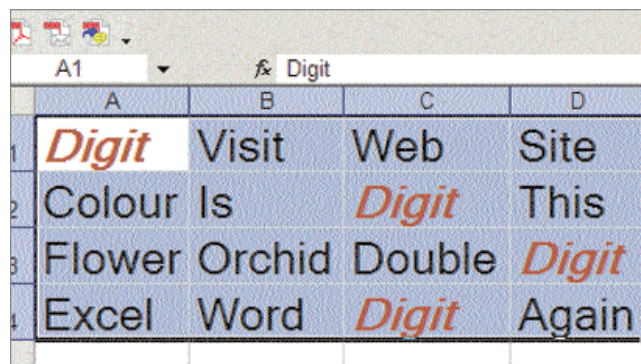
Using CF To Draw Attention

You can use the conditional formatting feature to help draw attention to cells that contain specific text in which you are interested. For instance, if you have a range of cells and you want to know which ones contain the letters "DIGIT", then you can do the following: first select the range of cells. Choose 'Conditional Formatting' from the Format menu. In the drop-down 'Condition' list, choose "Formula Is". In the formula box, enter the following formula. (Replace 'A1' with the address of the cell in the upper-left corner of the range you selected.)

=NOT(ISERR(SEARCH("DIGIT",A1)))



Choose a range of cells and apply conditional formatting by choosing "Formula Is"



Once you've applied your criteria, your specified word(s) will appear in your chosen format

Click 'Format'. Excel displays the 'Format Cells' dialog box. Using the controls in the dialog box, specify a format that you want used for those cells that contain the specified text. For instance, you may want bold text in a yellow typeface. Click 'OK' twice.

You can make this approach even more general-purpose by specifying a cell that contains what you want to search for. For instance, if you type "DIGIT" in cell F7, then you could replace the formula with the following:

=NOT(ISERR(SEARCH(\$F\$7,A1)))

Now, you can search for something different just by changing the characters in cell F7.

External Data Validation

Data validation allows you to control what information is entered into a worksheet. Validating based on information internal to a workbook is easy; validating to information in another

workbook can be a real pain. Normally, Excel expects you to specify your validation range as being on the same worksheet where you are defining the validation rule. If you try to enter a range that is on another worksheet or in another workbook, Excel brings up an error message.

What if you want the validation range to be on another worksheet, just so you don't clutter up the current worksheet with extraneous data? The easiest way to do that is to follow these general steps: first, select the range of cells you want to use as your data validation values. Choose 'Name' from the 'Insert' menu, and then 'Define' from the submenu. Excel displays the 'Define Name' dialog box. Enter a unique name for your data validation range, such as "MyValRange", then click 'OK'. Now select the cell for which you want to define a validation rule. Choose 'Validation' from the Data menu. Excel displays the 'Data Validation' dialog box.

Use the 'Allow' and 'Data' drop-down lists to specify how you want Excel to validate the data. Depending on your selections, you will see a Value, Minimum, or Maximum boxes appear in the dialog box. In the appropriate boxes (Value, Minimum, or Maximum), specify the name you gave your data validation range ("MyValRange"). Click 'OK'.

This approach works fine if the data validation range is in the same workbook. What if you want to use a data validation range that is in an entirely different workbook? You can trick Excel into accepting your external reference if, instead of specifying a name, you enter a formula such as the following:

=INDIRECT("[Book2]Sheet1!D6")

This formula uses the INDIRECT function to return the value at a cell on another worksheet, and the data validation feature will accept it with no problems. In this case the cell being checked is